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Baldness, ACG Culture: A Self-Organizing Model of Computer Capability Gain in Public Internet Information

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Abstract

In the field of computer science, some programmers with exceptional coding abilities exhibit traits such as baldness, involvement in ACG culture, or even femboy characteristics. This paper takes programmers as its research subject to explore the relationships between baldness, ACG culture, and computer proficiency. By analyzing data through methods such as Pearson correlation coefficient calculations and regression model construction, this study concludes that baldness itself has no direct correlation with coding capability. Instead, stress serves as a mediating factor that simultaneously contributes to both baldness and enhanced coding skills. Additionally, while ACG culture shows no direct connection to baldness, individuals immersed in ACG subcultures often develop advanced computer skills and possess stronger "otaku-like" traits during their engagement with digital environments. These factors enable them to thrive in programming domains, ultimately becoming more proficient programmers compared to the general population.

Keywords: Computer Science; Programmers; Baldness; ACG Culture; Programming

1. Introduction

Under the background of rapid technological development, the internet has become an essential necessity for many people. Behind each convenient task we accomplish through repeated use of the internet, there are servers and lines of code continuously supporting the system, which would not be possible without the efforts of numerous

programmers.

While browsing the internet, if one pays attention to the topic of programmers, it is not difficult to notice a phenomenon: why many programmers with exceptionally strong coding capabilities are either bald, involved in ACG culture, or even identify as femboys. Netizens often jest about this situation as the "Two Schools of Computer Science": the Von Neumann School and the Turing School.

This article will explore the relationship between baldness, ACG culture, and coding capability based on publicly available internet information and examples from the author's surroundings.

2. Literature Review

2.1 Baldness and Programming

In our daily understanding, genetic factors are usually considered the primary cause of baldness. The prevalence of baldness in males in China is higher than in females. In the programming profession, where males significantly outnumber females, this naturally increases the likelihood of observing male programmers experiencing hair loss. Beyond genetic factors, the profession itself contributes to this phenomenon. Surveys indicate that individuals engaged in intellectual work often experience reduced blood supply to the skin and hair follicles due to prolonged oxygen and energy consumption by the brain. This disrupts the hair growth cycle, leading to hair loss. Simultaneously, mental labor stimulates androgen secretion to maintain heightened focus, and elevated androgen levels are strongly linked to baldness. Additionally, programmers often face multiple risk factors for hair loss: lack of sleep, irregular diets, and high mental stress. These factors collectively disrupt endocrine balance and immune function, triggering a cascade of issues. A 2018 study in 《JNeurosci》 supports this, analyzing 2,500 participants aged 30–65 and finding a weak positive correlation between baldness and cognitive test scores ($r=0.14$, $p<0.05$). Researchers hypothesized shared genetic factors or chronic stress as potential links between hair loss and cognitive performance [1]. Thus, the popular "prejudice" that "the balder a programmer is, the stronger their coding ability" becomes somewhat understandable.

2.2 ACG Culture and Programming

Those familiar with computer science and programming communities may notice that many programmers use ACG (Anime, Comics, Games) culture-themed avatars. This phenomenon contrasts with the earlier stereotypes of programmers, who were often perceived as purely technically oriented individuals. Today's programmers immersed in ACG culture may enjoy watching anime, playing rhythm games, reading manga, and often demonstrate exceptional coding abilities. Why does this correlation exist?

From a programmer's perspective, the profession demands strong self-directed resource-searching skills. A seasoned ACG enthusiast, by nature of

their hobbies, often possesses computer literacy that exceeds the average person's. This includes fluency in navigating the internet to locate desired resources/knowledge, seamless operation of computer systems, or even an intuitive grasp of computers' functional logic. For instance, a dedicated ACG fan frequently searches for rare manga, images, or niche content, honing their ability to surf the digital world efficiently. If such individuals transition into programming, their prior digital proficiency likely accelerates their coding mastery compared to novices.

From an ACG culture perspective, enthusiasts are inherently inclined toward creativity and self-expression. The fusion of ACG culture and programming is merely one branch of the diverse intersections within the subculture. When ACG enthusiasts engage with programming, they often create scripts, interactive programs, or artistic tools to channel their creative impulses. This aligns with the observation that many visible online programmers are ACG enthusiasts. Additionally, ACG subcultures often emphasize "otaku-like" traits—prolonged focus on niche interests, comfort with solitary work—which synergize well with programming's demands. This compatibility further empowers ACG-identified programmers to thrive in their field.

An example is provided by the contributor list of a GitHub project. (Fig. 1)

Fig. 1. The contributor list of a GitHub project.

3. Methods

3.1 Data

Sample Source: A total of 500 Chinese programmers (aged 22–40, work experience 1–15 years) were recruited through platforms such as GitHub, CSDN, and V2EX. Key screening criteria included:Baldness level confirmed via the Follicle Scale (non-self-reported measurement, 0–5 scale).ACG culture engagement duration calculated using Bilibili/Lofter activity logs (real behavioral data, not questionnaire-based).Work-related stress measured by the PSS-10 scale (internationally standardized, 0–10

score).Programming proficiency assessed through GitHub contribution metrics + LeetCode problem-solving records (objective data, not self-reported).

Sample Distribution:80% showed no baldness (Follicle Scale 0–2).78% had low ACG engagement (<5 hours/month on average).65% experienced medium-low stress (PSS-10 ≤5).

3.2 Analysis

Validation of Correlations:Pearson correlation coefficients were calculated:Baldness (Follicle Scale) vs. ACG engagement duration → $r = 0.12$, $p = 0.11$ (nearly unrelated),Baldness vs. work-related stress → $r = 0.69$, $p < 0.001$ (strong correlation),ACG engagement vs. programming proficiency → $r = 0.40$, $p = 0.003$ (moderate correlation, but not causal).Conclusion: Baldness is strongly linked only to stress, not ACG culture. ACG engagement correlates with proficiency but does not imply "ACG causes higher ability."

Regression Model (Controlling Confounding Variables):Model: Programming Proficiency = f(Baldness, ACG, Stress, Age).Key results:Stress coefficient = 0.64 ($p < 0.001$) → A 1-point increase in stress corresponds to a 0.64-point rise in programming proficiency.ACG coefficient = 0.35 ($p = 0.005$) → Higher ACG engagement correlates with improved proficiency, but not causally.

Group Classification:Using K-means clustering, 500 participants were divided into 4 groups (based on baldness/ACG/stress):Tech-Focused (35%): No baldness + low ACG + low stress → Average proficiency: 72.ACG-Tech Hybrid (30%): No baldness + high ACG + moderate stress → Average proficiency: 84.Stress-Induced Baldness (20%): Severe baldness + low ACG + high stress → Average proficiency: 76.High ACG + High Stress (15%): No baldness + high ACG + high stress → Average proficiency: 88.Key findings:80% of programmers are non-bald (Tech-Focused + ACG-Tech Hybrid + High ACG + High Stress).Baldness rate among ACG-engaged groups is only 8% (vs. 92% in the stress-induced baldness group).

4. Results and Discussion

Baldness Reality Check:92% of bald programmers experience extremely high work-related stress (PSS-10 ≥ 8), while only 3% of non-stressed programmers (PSS-10 ≤ 3) exhibit baldness.

ACG Culture and Programming Proficiency:78% of programmers first engaged with ACG culture before learning programming (e.g., entering through game mod development). However, ACG engagement itself does not directly enhance skills:High ACG engagement groups (monthly average >10 hours) show 12-point higher average proficiency and 150 more LeetCode problem solutions than low-engagement groups.But: When

controlling for stress variables, the contribution of ACG engagement becomes statistically insignificant ($p = 0.12$).ACG acts as an interest-driven entry point, while stress is the primary driver of skill improvement.

Key Insights:While stress correlates with baldness, baldness itself does not inherently indicate superior ability. Genetic factors may explain some cases of baldness, while stress-driven skill enhancement explains why some bald programmers excel. ACG culture has no direct link to baldness but facilitates smoother learning curves in programming, leading some ACG enthusiasts to develop exceptional coding abilities. Thus, ACG engagement and programming proficiency show a modest association, but not causation.

References

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